

ST PETERSBURG

ST PETERSBURG Once Russia's capital, St Petersburg was built in the 18th century by Tsar Peter the Great as a "window on the West." Today, it is a popular tourist destination, full of grand palaces and extravagant architecture (left). The city spreads over some 40 islands, linked by a network of canals and rivers.

EDUCATION
Children go to school here from the age of 6 through 15, or 17. After a decline due to lack of money, the fall of communism in Russia's free schools was good and Russia is high, at 98 percent private schools.

The Church of the Savior on Spilled Blood marks the spot where Tsar Alexander II was murdered in 1881.

Sleeping Beauty is performed here by dancers from the Kirov Ballet.

